

forward. You are then asked to choose where you want to install your operating system. You need not install necessarily on your system if you have less space. Mac OS X Snow Leopard also installs on externals which are Mac formatted.



Choose Installation Destination

If you have booted from the Snow Leopard Install disk, your usual startup drive is idle. Hence you can use Disk Utility to erase it in case you need to free up space. You can also partition the disk now. We'll be covering Boot Camp later for those of you who want to get ahead of yourself and dream of a dual or triple boot system. To access facilities like partitioning and Disk Utility, go to Utilities on the Install OS X window.

A very sure way to go about installing any new operating system is to back up your data first. Usually termed as the "Archive and Install method", it has its benefits, primarily a backup for all your data. Though Snow Leopard's install is very clean and has little hiccups, you may still choose this strategy for safety. We'll show you how to backup your existing data using Time Machine in the coming chapters. As of now, let's stick to a basic install.